AIRCAT2501

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LEADER IN ADAPTIVE PREPARATION FOR CAT

AIRCAT2501 Dissection

If you've taken AIRCAT-2501, congratulations! Regardless of your scores/performance, you've taken a crucial step forward in your CAT preparation. The first step in learning how to swim is getting into the pool, and you've done that. You are ahead of everyone who is still circling on the outside and wondering about the temperature of the water or the depth of the pool :)

Getting used to any new format and/or testing platform does take time, so you need to be patient. However, if you see something like this as a means to an end, as something that gives you invaluable exposure to a test that not only tested your ability but also your temperament, as something that is just a learning ground for the real CAT, then this test might just have been a defining point of your CAT Prep.

Since not much is known about the composition of this year's CAT except that it would have 3 sections of equal time duration and almost equal number of questions, we will try and ensure that you experience a decent variety (until all variables become clear) in the AIRCATs so that you find it easier to adapt to whatever surprises CAT comes up with finally. A calm head, unflinching concentration for the duration of the test and devoting some time for planning your approach initially and then reviewing/adapting intermittently are most crucial to your chances of success in an exam such as the CAT.

It would not be surprising if you feel that your performance level was significantly lower than ideal. That just means you have a long way to go, and the scope of improvement is tremendous. And converting knowledge into score is a skill that you need to get better at.

The VARC and QA sections of AIRCAT2501 would have been a positive experience for most of you, especially in contrast to DILR. With no surprise in terms of pattern, this AIRCAT gave you enough room to warm up to AIRCATs, instead of presenting a big challenge like some future ones surely will.

Not only did the AIRCAT reflect a likely variant of CAT-2025 (based on the most recent CATs), it also very closely reflected some of the recent CAT papers in terms of difficulty level of various sections and types of questions.

For most of you, the first and the third sections were perhaps much easier as compared the second section. And so, this AIRCAT would have highlighted the need to enter a test with an open mind, with no fixed number of attempts as being good. Trusting your ability and sticking to the basics (after which your speed will automatically adapt to the toughness of the test) should have done the trick for most.

So, if you thought that say 9-10 attempts are good in the quant section, well, on an easier test such as this, a relatively higher number would have been ideal. The DILR section on the other hand was relatively tough with no real easy set. But all you needed to clear the cut-off was around 12 marks – something that even 4 right questions could have ensured. So, cracking just one set would have gotten you there, and more. Realizing that "even a little can be a lot" when a section is tough is a lesson you should carry with you for the rest of your prep.

Let us look at a detailed sectional analysis in terms of (relative) difficulty level:

	Easy	Intermediate	Difficult	Difficulty Level	Indicative Cut-offs Correct Questions/(Marks)
Section I (VRC)	6	9	9	Easy	13 (29)
Section II (DILR)	0	12	10	Intermediate to Difficult	6 (13)
Section II (QA)	9	9	4	Easy	12 (25)
Overall	15	30	23	Intermediate	32 (72)

Tentative sectional and overall benchmarks are given below:

	98%ile	95%ile	90%ile	85%ile
Section I (VRC)	36	32	28	24
Section II (DILR)	21	16	12	9
Section III (QA)	35	29	23	20
Overall	81	65	54	48

At MBAGuru, we put in every possible effort to ensure that our students get the best possible simulation of the actual CAT. The AIRCATs are very closely mapped with the actual online CAT levels. The variation in degree of difficulty of sections/overall tests are deliberately designed to help you prepare for all likely and possible variations in the CAT. Our team of mentors, who prepare the AIRCATs, appear for CAT every year, and the year-to-year changes in AIRCATs are carried out basis their detailed inputs.

Here's a word of advice: There are several test series available to a student from various coaching institutes. A few of these are extremely difficult at an overall level. From 2003 to 2006, the CAT was relatively difficult at an overall level and such a test series probably made sense. But while opting for a difficult test series might have been a good strategy at that point in time, the subsequent changes including reduced number and level of questions mean it is no longer a sensible choice. A good test series has to ADAPT to the changes, and reflect the more recent and likely future trend of CAT. When some institutes treat it as a marketing strategy, and offer FREE and difficult tests just to attract students, unfortunately, it's the students who lose out. Most popular notions, even among CAT aspirants, fail to capture this nuance.

That said, one of the sections being tougher than the other two is very likely possibility in the CAT, although this relatively difficult section has kept changing every few years. So, while DILR has been relatively tough for the past few years, whether it will be DILR or one of the other two sections that may see an increase in

difficulty level is anybody's guess. We will ensure enough variations for you to be prepared for any eventuality. And that should be one of the main purposes of a Test Series, apart from practice and strategy formation!

The past data/empirical evidence shows that you can usually add around 2-5 %ile to the AIRCAT scores to estimate the approximate %ile in actual CAT. Hence, if you clear the mentioned cut-offs, you would stand a good chance to getting calls from 2-3 IIMs, assuming no significant deviations from other parameters of selection used by each IIM. Also, a student getting between 75%ile-90%ile in AIRCAT can expect around 3-4%ile higher. Those around 60%ile can expect a higher increase (than even 5%ile) and those above 95%ile too can expect an increase in actual CAT though it would be a smaller increase.

Disclaimer: The above analysis is generic in nature and cannot factor in your individual strengths and weaknesses beyond a point and hence please adapt it to suit your specific set of strengths and weaknesses!